MIL-M-15991D(AS)
14 February 1986
SUPERSEDING
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15 May 1985

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

MARKING MACHINE, HAND-OPERATED

This specification is approved for use within the Naval Air Systems Command, Department of the Navy, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers hand-operated marking machines.

1.2 Classification. This specification covers one type of hand-operated marking machine of the following styles, as specified (see 6.2).

Style A - For marking on wire and cable insulation and flexible electrical insulation sleeving.
Style B - For marking on flat surfaces of fabric, leather and plastics.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-P-40	Packaging and Packing of Hand tools

Beneficial comments, (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to the Department of the Navy, Naval Air Engineering Center, Systems Engineering and Standardization Department (Code 93), Lakehurst, NJ 08733-5100, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 3695

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MILITARY

MIL-W-5086/1	Wire, Electric, Polyvinyl Chloride Insulated Nylon Jacket, Tin-Coated Copper Conductor, 600 Volt, 105 Degrees C
MIL-W-5088	Wiring, Aerospace Vehicle
MIL-H-5606	Hydraulic Fluid, Petroleum Base, Aircraft, Missile, and Ordnance
MIL-I-7444	Insulation Sleeving, Electrical, Flexible

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

(Copies of specifications and standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents. The following other Government documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues shall be those in effect on the date of the solicitation.

NATIONAL BUREAU OF STANDARDS
Handbook H-28 - Screw Thread Standards for Federal Services

(Copies of handbooks, and other Government documents required by the contractor in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

2.2 Other publications. The following document(s) form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DODISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents not listed in the DODISS shall be the issue of the nongovernment documents which is current on the date of the solicitation.

UNDERWRITERS LABORATORIES, INC. STANDARDS FOR SAFETY
UL 498 Attachment Plugs and Receptacles
UL 499 Electric Heating Appliances

(Application for copies should be addressed to Underwriters laboratories, Inc., 333 Phingsten Rd., Northbrook, IL 60062.)

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2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein (except for associated detail specifications, specification sheets or MS standards), the text of this specification shall take precedence. Nothing in this specification, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Illustrations. Figures 1 through 4 are for the convenience of identification, and are not intended to preclude the purchase of marking machines which are otherwise in acordance with the requirements of this specification.

3.2 Design. Marking machines furnished shall be of the manufacturers' latest design. The design shall be such as to provide convenient and safe operation. All parts of the machines shall be new, designed and constructed to the requirements listed herein. All parts subject to wear, breakage and distortion shall be readily accessible for adjustment and repair. The entire machine shall be UL approved. Asbestos shall not be used in the construction of this machine.

3.2.1 Safety devices. The marking machine shall be fitted with safety devices or coverings for all parts that present safety hazards. All coverings shall be designed to provide access to guarded parts.

3.2.2 Bearings. Bearings and sliding surfaces shall be cast iron, steel, bronze or commercially available ball or roller bearings where required and conform to commercial requirements.

3.2.3 Lubrication. All bearings (except sealed-for-life type) and other working parts shall be provided with ample and suitable means of lubrication.

3.2.4 Interchangeability. All replaceable parts shall be constructed to definite standards, tolerances, and clearances in order that any such part of a particular type or model may be replaced or adjusted without requiring modification.

3.2.5 Material. The material to be used in the construction of marking machines shall be of uniform quality and condition, and shall conform in composition, heat-treatment, and suitability to the standard practices of manufacturer's producing equipment of the type called for in this specification.

3.3 Construction. The marking machine and its equipment shall be complete so that when installed in its intended application it can be used for any operation for which it was designed. Construction shall be free from any characteristics or defects that will prevent the machine from passing any of the examinations and tests specified herein.

3.3.1 Castings and forgings. All castings and forgings shall be free fom defects, scale and mismatching. In no event shall such processes as welding, peening, plugging or filling with cold solders or metallic pastes be used on castings or forgings for reclaiming any parts of flexible shaft machines.

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3.3.2 Welding, brazing or soldering. Welding, brazing or soldering shall be employed only where those operations are included in fabrication of the original design. These operations shall not be employed as repair measures for defective parts.

3.3.3 Surfaces. All surfaces of all castings, forgings, or molded parts shall be cleaned and free of sand, dirt, fins, sprues, scale, flux or other harmful or extraneous materials. External surfaces shall be smooth and all edges shall be rounded or beveled.

3.3.4 Painting. Marking machine shall be painted in accordance with the manufacturer's standard practice.

3.3.5 Fastening devices. All screws, pins, bolts, and similar parts shall be installed with means of preventing loss of tightness. All such parts when subjected to removal or adjustment, shall not be swaged, peened, stacked or otherwise permanently deformed.

3.3.6 Threads. All threaded parts shall be in the inch system and shall conform to Handbook H-28.

3.4 Marking machines, style A. Style A marking machine shall be similar to figure 1 and 2 and shall comply with 3.4.1 through 3.4.4.

3.4.1 Type. Type shall be brass, zinc or equivalent hard surfaced material able to retain its character with repeated heatings and imprintings. Type shall have a hardness at 70°F of not less than 50 on the Rockwell "B" scale.

3.4.1.1 Wire marking type. Wire marking letter and numeral type sets shall be furnished as shown in table I in radius of type face for use on wire diameters listed for the character height and position specified (see 6.2).

Table I - Wire marking, type for style A marking machine.

Character		Radius of type face	Used on wire of outside diameter	
Height	Position		Minimum	Maximum
Inch		Inch	Inch	Inch
0.065	Vertical	0.024	0.039	0.100
0.050	Horizontal	0.027	0.052	0.070
1/16	Horizontal	0.038	0.068	0.095
5/64	Horizontal	0.055	0.096	0.165
7/64	Horizontal	0.125	0.166	and larger

3.4.1.2 Sleeve marking type. Letter and numeral type sets for marking insulation sleeve shall have a flat face and shall be furnished in 0.052, 1/16-, 5/64-, 7/64- and 1/8-inch heights as specified (see 6.2).

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3.4.1.3 Type sets. A set of letters shall consist of 7 pieces of gothic style type for each letter of the alphabet. A set of numerals shall consist of 10 pieces of type for each digit, 0 through 9, inclusive. Other figures of type such as arrows, stars, and asterisks, shall also be available at the option of the procuring agency. All edges of the stamping face shall be provided with radii, to eliminate sharp corners or edges that may cause impairment of dielectric strength of sleeving or wire insulation.

3.4.2 Components. Marking machine shall consist of frame, base, type assembly, heating unit, electrical equipment, foil assembly, operating mechanism, holding fixtures and foil.

3.4.2.1 Frame. The frame shall be designed to provide support and align the various assemblies. The frame shall be of sufficient strength and rigidity to insure proper performance. The frame shall be attached to or be integral with a base having provision for bench mounting.

3.4.2.2 Base. The base shall be machined flat and true and be designed to receive various holding fixtures.

3.4.2.2.1 Base platform. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the machine base shall be securely attached to a hardwood base platform at least 3/4-inch thick or a suitable metal base platform. The base platform shall be attached to provide working area in front of the marking machine.

3.4.2.3 Type assembly. Type assembly shall consist of type, type holder, type holding head, and heating unit.

3.4.2.3.1 Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), each machine (Type A only) shall be supplied with the following sets of 19-point body type:

(a) One set of capital letters 5/64-inch high with a face radius of 0.055 inch (for wire).
(b) One set of numerals 5/64-inch high with a face radius of 0.055 inch (for wire).
(c) Ten each, arrows, hyphens, and asterisks, and 16 spacers of the 4-point size and M Quads.
(d) One set of capital letters 5/64-inch high, flat face (for sleeving).
(e) One set of numerals 5/64-inch high, flat face (for sleeving).
(f) Ten each arrows, hyphens and asterisks and 16 each spacers of the 4-point size and M Quads.
(g) Two type cases (one for each set) with compartment for holding type in alphabetical and numerical order.

3.4.2.3.2 Type holding head. The type holding head shall be in close proximity to the heating unit for rapid heating. The holder shall clamp the type in the proper position for the imprinting through the foil. Change of type holder shall be accomplished without use of tools.

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3.4.2.3.3 Type holders. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), type holders for style A shall be capable of securely holding in alignment 1 to 18 digits of type. Style A machines shall be designed to accept a 1-line type holder 2 inches wide. Three type holders shall be provided with each machine.

Table of Temperature Range	
Style A Style B	150° to 500°F 150° to 300°F Min.

3.4.2.4 Heating unit. The heating unit shall operate on 115 volt alternating current (a.c.) and shall be manually controlled within a temperature range of 150° to 500°F. A visual heat indicator graduated to 500°F in 10°F increments shall be provided. A bright indicator light controlled by a convenient switch shall be provided in series with the heater and heater control device.

3.4.2.5 Electrical components. All electrical components including cable assembly, switch, wiring and heating element shall conform to applicable requirements of UL 498 and UL 499.

3.4.2.5.1 Cable assembly. Each marking machine shall be supplied with a cable assembly as an integral part of the equipment. Cable assembly shall consist of at least 3 feet of three-conductor commercially designated SJ or S type cable of the capacity required for the heater size furnished. Connector plugs shall conform to UL 498 requirements for two-pole, 3 wire grounding devices rated 15 amperes, 125 volts.

3.4.2.5.2 Switch. Switch shall be two-pole single throw and shall conform to the switch requirements of UL 499.

3.4.2.5.3 Wiring and heating element. Wiring and heating element shall conform to the applicable requirements of UL 499 for spacings, connections and protection from mechanical damage.

3.4.2.6 Foil assembly. Means shall be provided for supporting the rolls of foil in the proper position for imprinting of the type. The assembly shall be capable of using foil 1, 1-1/2 or 2 inches in width (Style A only). The foil assembly shall be properly linked to the operating mechanism for suitable feeding of the foil.

3.4.2.7 Operating mechanism. There shall be a handle of sufficient length to easily actuate the operating mechanism. Each imprinting motion of the handle shall automatically advance the foil to its next impression space. There shall be an adjustable stop to govern the impression depth of the type.

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3.4.2.8 Wire holding fixture. Wire holding fixtures for style A shall permit the wire to be moved smoothly through the fixture while retaining wire in the proper marking position and permit rapid interchange of different wire size fixtures. Holding fixtures shall be designed with a marking capacity of 18 digits of type. The fixtures shall be interchangeable so that fixture for additional wire diameters will fit the machine. Outside diameter of wire insulation shall be specified for marking machine requiring holding fixtures for each size (B & S gage) wire to be marked. Exact wire size and type of insulation shall be specified (see 6.2).

3.4.2.8.1 Insulation sleeving holding fixture. Each machine shall be furnished with a universal electrical sleeving holding fixture unless otherwise specified.

3.4.2.9 Marking foil. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), 10 spools of marking foil (9 black and 1 white) shall be provided with each machine. Colors other than black and white shall be available at the option of the procuring agency. The width of the foil shall be 2 inches (Style A), and shall have a minimum of 100 feet per spool. The foil shall be of such quality that when printed on the wire, it will be permanently applied. The marking shall be legible and there shall be no running, blurring, bleeding, or fading of the finished marking. The pigment used in the foil shall not be conducive to and shall not support growth of fungi that would cause dielectric leakage through the insulation. The foil shall permanently and legibly mark wire and cable insulation and flexible sleeving including coverings of synthetic rubber, and fluorocarbons. Each roll of foil shall be separately packed. Packaging shall insure a shelf life of not less than 1 year. Separate packages, containing a roll of foil shall include the following identifying information:

(a) Manufacturer's stock number.
(b) Color.
(c) "Useful life" - expiration date.
(d) "How to use" instructions.

3.4.3 Weight. Net weight of machine shall be less than 30 pounds.

3.4.4 Size. Maximum size shall be 8-1/4 inches wide, 13-1/4 inches deep and 14-1/4 inches high.

3.5 Marking machines, style B. Style B marking machines shall be similar to figures 3 and 4 and comply with requirements for style A except for type (see 3.5.1), type holders (see 3.5.2), holding fixtures (see 3.5.3), foil assembly and foil (see 3.5.4).

3.5.1 Type. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), each style B machine shall be furnished with the following 18 point gothic type sets.

(a) One set of letters. A set of letters shall consist of 7 each, A through Z.
(b) One set of numerals. A set of numerals shall consist of 10 each, 0 through 9.
(c) 7 each - periods, commas, quotation marks and spacers.

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3.5.1.1 Additional type. When specified (see 6.2), additional type letters, numerals, or characters in point sizes 10, 12, 14, 18 or 24 gothic style shall be furnished for style B machines.

3.5.2 Type holders. Style B machines shall be designed for accepting, type holders, with 1, 2 or 3 lines of type, 3 inches in length. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), each style B machine shall be furnished with three 3 line type holders.

3.5.2.1 Additional type holders. When specified (see 6.2), 3 each 1-line and 3 each 2-line type holders shall be furnished.

3.5.3 Holding fixture. Holding fixture shall be a smooth, flat plate, provided with a means of positioning and supporting the material to be marked.

3.5.4 Foil assembly. Means shall be provided for suporting the rolls of foil in the proper position for imprinting of the type. The assembly shall be capable of using foil 1, 2, or 3 inches in width (Style B only). The foil assembly shall be properly linked to the operating machine for suitable feeding of the foil.

3.5.5 Marking foil. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), 9 spools of marking foil (5 gold, 2 silver, 1 black and 1 white), shall be provided for each machine. The width of the foil shall be 3 inches and shall have a minimum length of 100 feet per spool. The foil shall be of such quality, that when printed on suitable fabrics, leather and plastics, it shall be permanently applied. The marking shall be legible and there shall be no running, blurring, bleeding or fading of the finished marking. Each roll of foil shall be separately packed. Packaging shall insure a shelf life of not less than one year. Separate packages, containing a roll of foil shall include the following identifying information:

(a) Manufacturer's stock number.
(b) Color.
(c) "Useful life" - Expiration date.
(d) "How to use" Instructions.

3.6 Identification plate. A corrosion-resistant metal plate permanently and legibly marked to include the following information shall be securely attached to both A and B style marking machines.

(a) Manufacturer's name or trade-mark.
(b) Manufaturer's model or serial number.

3.7 Handbook of instructions. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the manufacturer shall supply two copies of his regular instructions and parts list with each machine. The book shall include all illustrations, instructions and necessary data for adjustment or repair. Parts list shall include manufacturer's part numbers and ordering instructions.

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3.8 Workmanship. Workmanship of marking machines shall be of the quality prevailing among manufacturers normally producing marking machines of the styles specified herein.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items must meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of assuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling in quality conformance does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to acceptance of defective material.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Lot. All marking machines of the same size and style presented shall be selected from each lot in conformance with MIL-STD-105 at inspection level II.

4.2.2 Sampling for quality conformance. A random sample shall be selected from each lot in conformance with MIL-STD-105 at inspection level II.

4.3 Quality conformance inspection. Quality conformance inspection shall be applied to each sample selected in accordance with 4.2.2. Quality conformance inspection shall consist of the following:

(a) Examination (see 4.3.1).
(b) Tests (see 4.3.2).
(c) Inspection of preservation, packaging, packing and storage (see 4.5).

4.3.1 Examination. Each of the sample marking machine selected in accordance with 4.2.2 shall be examined for design, size and dimensions and workmanship to determine conformance with this specification. Examination shall be conducted in accordance with table II. Accepted quality level to be as indicated. Nonconforming marking machines shall not be offered for delivery and if the nonconforming marking machines in any one sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented shall be subject to rejection.

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Table II. Classification of defects.

Categories	Defects
Major	AQL 2.5 percent defective
101	Marking machines not of style specified.
102	Component parts missing, damaged, defective or not as specified.
103	Parts not interchangeable
104	Type not as specified
105	Operation of heating unit not as specified
106	Electrical components not as specified
107	Type holders not as specified
108	Holding fixtures not as specified
Minor	AQL 4 percent defective
201	Evidence of improper workmanship, poor assembly

4.3.2 Tests. Each sample selected in accordance with 4.2.2 shall be tested to determine conformance to the requirements of this specification. AQL shall be 2.5 percent defective. Nonconforming machines shall not be offered for delivery and if the number of defective marking machines exceeds the acceptance number for the samples tested the lot represented shall be subject to rejection. Quality conformance tests shall consist of the tests specified in 4.4.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Dielectric test - equipment. Each style machine shall be subject to a dielectric test of twice rated voltage plus 1000 volts (r.m.s.), 60 cycles, a.c., for a period of one minute between each lead of the power circuit and the frame of the machine.

4.4.2 Style A, marking machine tests. Style A, marking machines shall be subject to the tests specified in 4.4.2.1 through 4.4.2.4.

4.4.2.1 Dielectric test - insulation. Dielectric integrity of marked wire insulation shall be conducted on a sample of insulated wire conforming to each size wire holding fixture supplied with the order. The sample shall be at least one foot long. The dielectric test shall be applied upon at least four marked characters of each sample at random spacings. The insulation shall withstand, without breakdown for one minute, the application of a test potential of maximum rated voltage.

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4.4.2.2 Warm immersion test (solvent resistance). A piece of wire size AN-18, 3 feet long, conforming to MIL-W-5086 type 1 shall be marked at approximately 6-inch intervals by the machine on test. The machine shall mark the test sample with a number having 12 digits in accordance with MIL-W-5088. After marking, the sample wire shall be fully immersed in hydraulic fluid conforming to MIL-H-5606 for a period of 2 hours with the fluid being at a continuous temperature of 125°F. After the immersion period, the sample wire shall be removed from the fluid, and excess fluid removed with a clean dry cloth. A blotting action shall be applied to the wire marking in the removal of the excess fluid. The marking on the wire shall be perfectly legible, and there shall be no fading, blurring, running together, or bleeding, of the print.

4.4.2.3 Warm immersion test for legibility. The warm immersion test shall also be conducted on a piece of 1/2-inch flexible electrical insulation sleeving, 3 feet long, conforming to MIL-I-7444. The marking on the wire shall be perfectly legible, and there shall be no fading, blurring, running together, or bleeding, of the print.

4.4.2.4 High temperature marking test. A piece of wire sleeving for size AN-18, 3 feet long, conforming to MIL-W-5086, type 1 shall be marked at approximately 6-inch intervals using a marking temperature of 500°F. Illegible marking from softening of the type or improper action of the marking foil shall be cause for rejection of the type or foil, as applicable.

4.4.3 Style B, marking machine test. Style B, marking machines shall be tested by marking three specimens each of the respective material for the style machine. Marking shall be with the maximum capacity of the type holder. Marking temperature shall be the optimum recommended by the manufacturer for the respective material. There shall be no fading, blurring, running together or bleeding of the print.

4.5 Inspection of preservation, packaging, packing and marking for shipment and storage. Preservation, packaging, packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be inspected to verify conformance with section 5.

5. PACKAGING

(The preparation for delivery requirements specified herein apply only for direct Government procurements. Preparation for delivery requirements or referenced documents listed in section 2 do not apply unless specifically stated in the contract or order. Preparation for delivery requirements for products procured by contractors shall be specified in the individual order.)

5.1 Preservation packaging, packing, and marking. Marking machines shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with level A or C, packed level A, B or C and marked in accordance with the requirements of PPP-P-40.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Hand operated marking machines shall be used for marking letters, figures and symbols. Style A shall be used on outer insulation of electric wires, cables, and insulating electrical sleeving. Style B shall be used on various materials such as fabrics, leather and plastics.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Style required (see 1.2).
(c) Wire and sleeve marking type, specify character height and radii (see 3.4.1.1 and 3.4.1.2) (Style A only).
(d) Specify base platform if different (see 3.4.2.2.1)..
(e) Specify type; style A see 3.4.1; and style B see 3.5.1, and 3.5.1.1 when specified.
(f) Type holders specify extra capacity when required (see 3.4.2.3.3 and 3.5.2).
(g) For style A marking machine specify holding fixture wire size, outside insulation diameter and type of insulation (see 3.4.2.8).
(h) Specify sleeve holding fixture when required for style A (see 3.4.2.8.1).
(h) Specify sleeving holding fixture when required for style A (see 3.4.2.8.1).
(i) Foil assembly; for style A see 3.4.2.6 and for style B (see 3.5.4).
(j) Number of spools of marking foil and colors required; for style A see 3.4.2.9 and for style B see 3.5.5.
(k) Instruction book requirements, if different, (see 3.7).
(l) Level of preservation and packaging and packing required (see 5.1).

6.3 Subject term keyword listing.

Hand-operated marking machine.
Machine, marking, hand-operated.
Marking, flat surface of fabric, leather, plastic.
Marking machine, hand-operated.
Marking, electric wire and cable insulation or sleeving.
Operated marking machine, hand.

6.4 Changes form previous issue. Asterisks (or vertical lines) are not used in this revision to identify changes, with respect from the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

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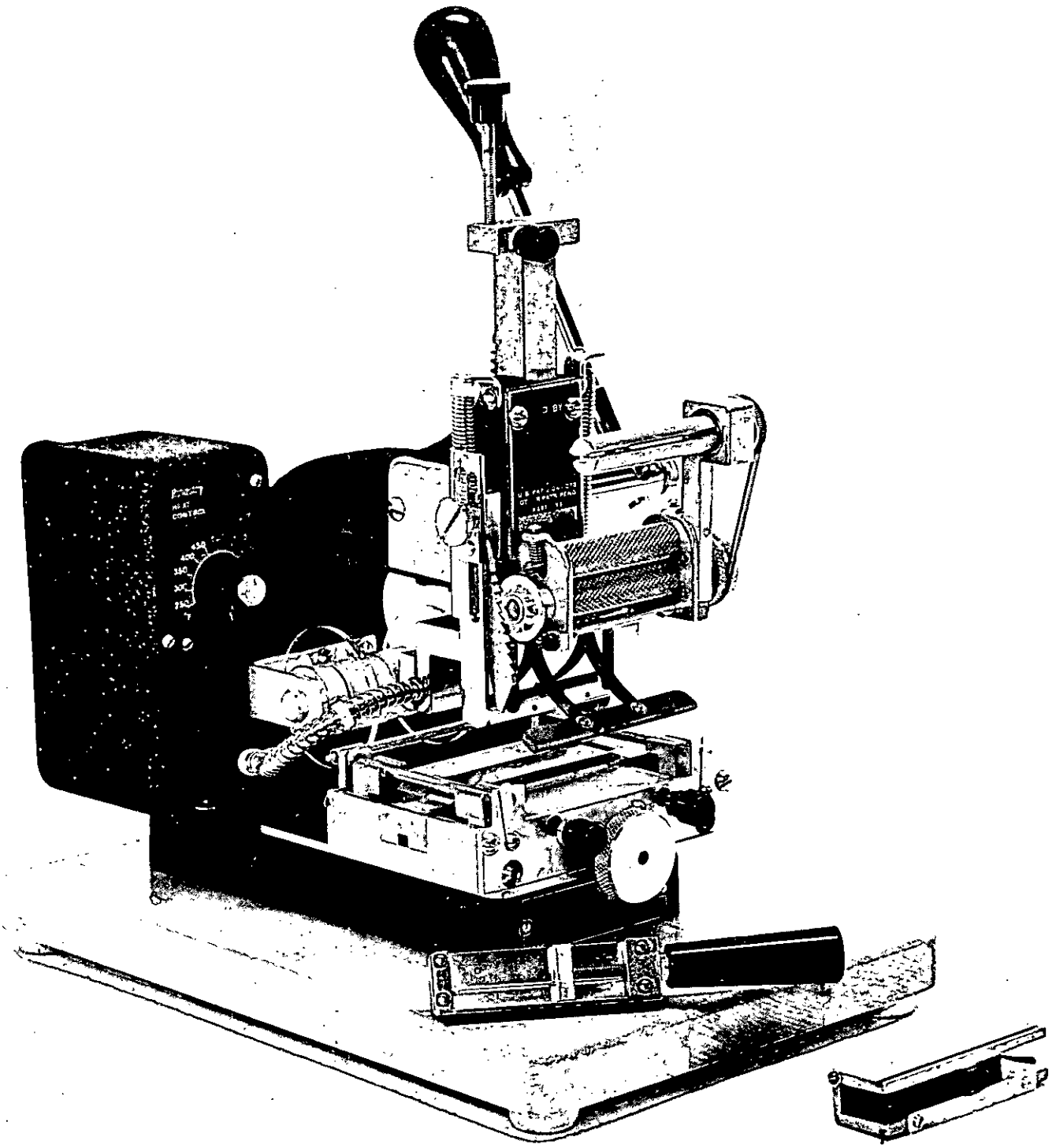


Figure 1. Style A hand-operated marking machine.

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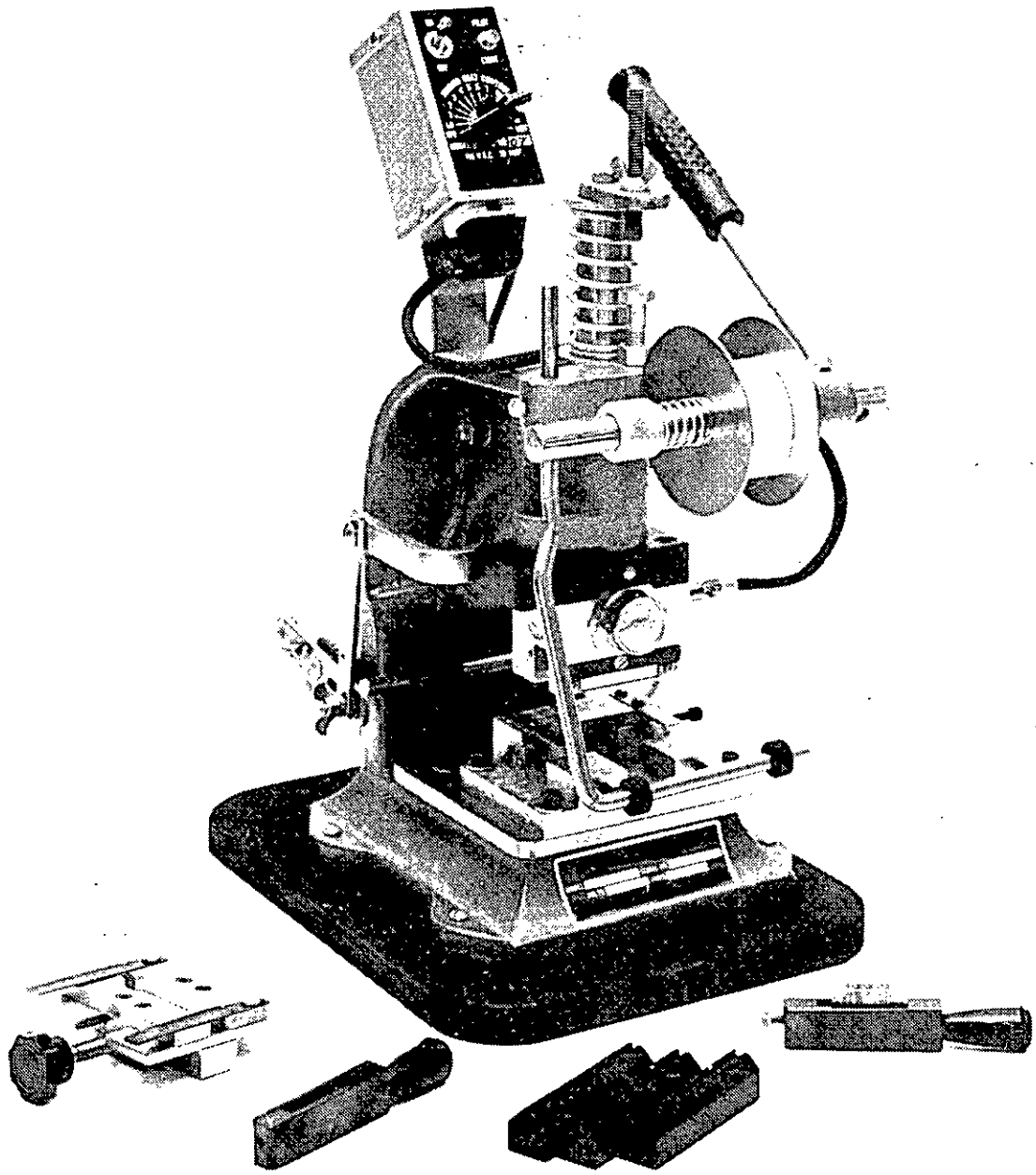


Figure 2. Style A hand-operated marking machine.

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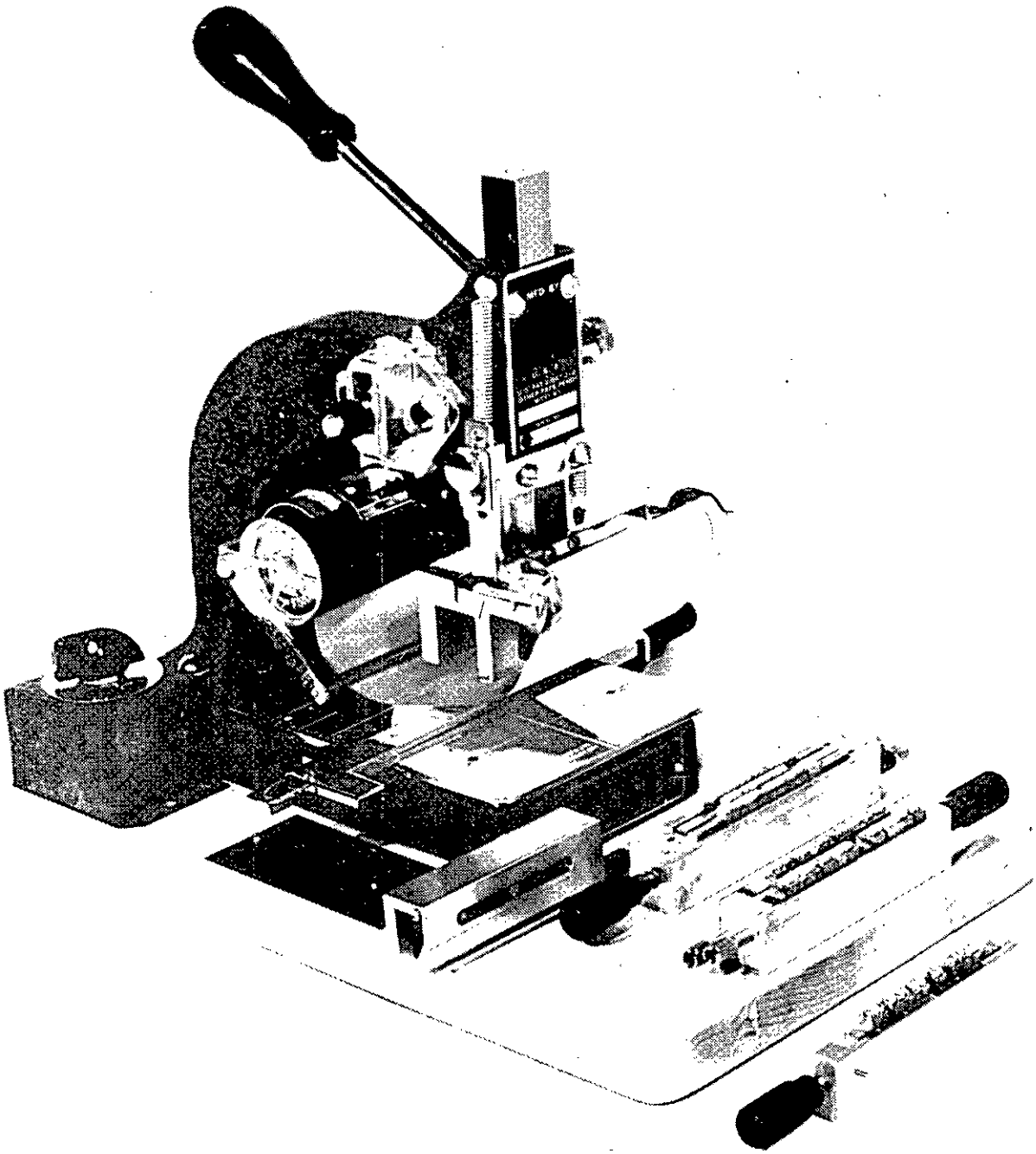


FIGURE 3. Style B hand-operated marking machine.

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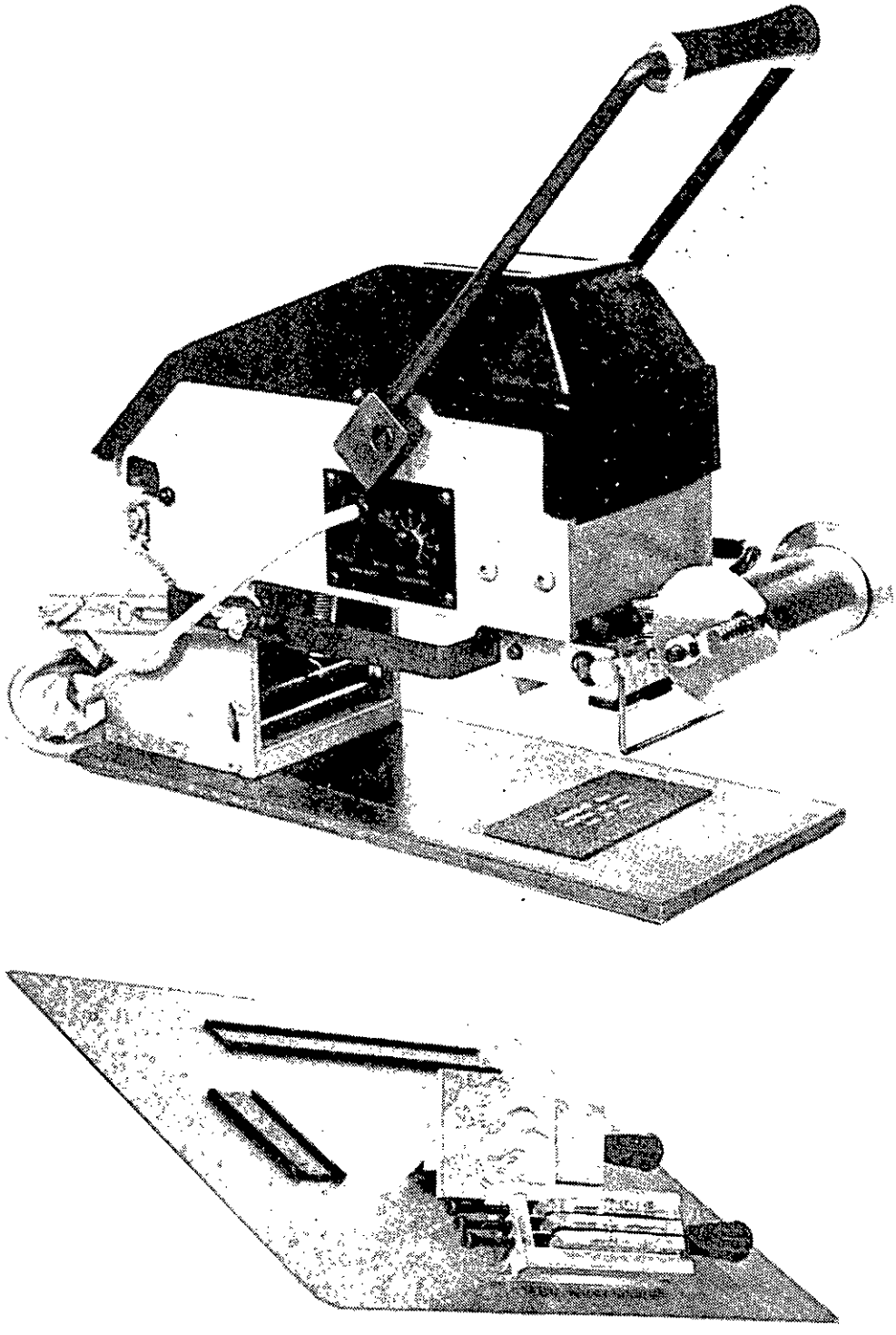


FIGURE 4. Style B hand-operated marking machine.

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